

include: urban air and water pollution resulting in global warming and climate change; exorbitant levels of urban solid waste, inadequate urban transport.

Policy Initiatives

The urbanisation in India is inevitable thus, the need for solving the various problems associated with it requires a combination of actions, starting with increased investment; strengthening the framework for governance, and most importantly capacity building for the people and the institutions engage in urban affairs.

Recognising the vast impact that Urbanisation has on the environment, the Indian government committed its Intended Nationally Determined Contribution (INDC) to United Nation Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) in 2015. The INDC centres around India's policies and programmes on promotion of clean energy, resilient urban centres, promotion of waste to wealth, safe, smart and sustainable green transportation network, abatement of pollution and efforts to fight the build-up of carbon by enhancing the carbon sink through creation of forest and tree cover.

The government of India has launched various programmes to address urban governance issues and gaps in infrastructure. Some of the key programmes include the Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation (AMRUT), Heritage City Development and Augmentation Yojana (HRIDAY), Smart Cities Mission, Clean India Mission and R-Urban Mission.

The Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016 (RERA): The RERA is one of the significant reforms implemented in the real estate sector with an objective to ensure regulation and promote real estate sector in an efficient and transparent manner and to protect the interest of home buyers.

The Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana- Urban (PMAY-U)– which envisions ‘Housing for All-Urban’, was launched in June, 2015 to provide pucca house with basic amenities to all eligible urban poor by 2022.

The country is participating in the United Nations’ “New Urban Agenda”, which aims to make cities more networked, closer to their citizens and more sustainable in the future. In the “Housing for all” project, the government aims to provide affordable housing even for the poorest – a total of 20 million houses in more than 2,500 cities. And with the “Smart Cities Mission”, more than 100 urban spaces are to be transformed into digitally networked conurbations.

5.4 SOCIAL INFRASTRUCTURE: GROWTH AND POLICY ISSUES

5.4.1 Education

India holds an important place in the global education industry. By 2030, India is set to have the largest working age population in the world. Not only do they need literacy but they need both job and life skills. This provides a great opportunity for the education sector. India's educational system broadly comprises school education (elementary, secondary and higher secondary), higher education (general and professional) and vocational education. The Ministry of Human

Resource Development (MHRD) is the nodal ministry for the sector. Expenditure in education sector as percentage of GDP increased from 2.8 per cent in 2014-15 to 3.1 per cent in 2019-20. As per the data released by Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), the total amount of Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) inflow into the education sector in India stood at US\$ 2.47 billion from April 2000 to March 2019.

India has seen a rapid expansion in the higher education sector since 2001. There has been a dramatic rise in the number of higher education institutions (HEIs) and enrolment has increased fourfold. The Indian higher education system is now one of the largest in the world, with 993 Universities, 39931 Colleges and 10725 Stand Alone Institutions. Despite the increased access to higher education in India, challenges remain. Low employability of graduates, poor quality of teaching, weak governance, insufficient funding, and complex regulatory norms continue to plague the sector. India's gross enrolment ratio (GER) in 2018-19 was 26.3 per cent but still far from meeting the MHRD's target of achieving 50 per cent GER by 2035.

Government Initiatives

Indian educational policy and reforms emphasised on overcoming challenges to improve low enrolment ratio in higher education, low quality of teaching and learning, constraints on research capacity and innovation, uneven growth and access to learning opportunities, etc. Some of the major initiatives taken by the Government of India are:

- SWAYAM (Study Webs of Active learning for Young Aspiring Minds)– a programme initiated by Government of India and designed to achieve the three cardinal principles of Education Policy viz., access, equity and quality.
- The National Digital library of India (NDLI)– a project initiated under the National Mission on Education through Information and Communication Technology (NMEICT) to develop a virtual repository of learning resources with a single-window search facility.
- The Mission of Unnat Bharat Abhiyan to leverage the intellectual capital of higher educational institutions for the upliftment of rural India.
- The Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya National Mission on Teachers and Teaching (PMMNMTT) to address issues related to teachers and teaching.
- Prime Minister Research Fellows (PMRF) scheme to support 1000 bright undergraduate students every year, for direct admission in the research programmes in the reputed institutions like IISc, IITs.
- The National Institutional Ranking Framework (NIRF) adopted by the MHRD to rank institutions of higher education in India.
- Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan – a Centrally Sponsored Scheme in partnership with State Governments for universalising elementary education across the country.
- National Education Policy 2020: The National Education Policy (NEP), 2020 – approved by the Union Cabinet on 29th July 2020 to make way for large scale, transformational reforms in both school and higher education sectors – is built on the foundational pillars of Access, Equity, Quality,

Affordability and Accountability. Key highlights of the policy include:

- Ensuring Universal Access at all levels of school education;
 - Early Childhood Care and Education with new Curricular and Pedagogical Structure;
 - Reforms in school curricula and pedagogy;
 - Emphasis on promoting multilingualism and Indian languages;
 - Assessment reforms;
 - Equitable and inclusive education;
 - Robust and transparent processes for recruitment of teachers and merit-based performance;
 - Exposure of vocational education in school and higher education system;
 - Increasing GER in higher education to 50 per cent by 2035;
 - Holistic Multidisciplinary Education with multiple entry/exit options;
 - Expansion of open and distance learning to increase GER.
 - The Centre and the States to work together to increase the public investment in Education sector to reach 6 per cent of GDP at the earliest.
- In pursuance with the Prime Minister's vision for 'Transforming India', Ministry of Human Resource Development took a leap forward in transforming education sector with the motto of "Education for All, Quality Education". MHRD has launched—
 - (i) Pradhan Mantri Innovative Learning Program– DHRUV; (ii) NISHTHA– National Initiative for School Heads' and Teachers' Holistic Advancement; (iii) Integrated Online junction for School Education 'Shagun'; (iv) a five-year vision plan named Education Quality Upgradation and Inclusion Programme (EQUIP); (v) Several new schemes in Higher Education Department to boost research and Innovation culture in the country.
 - Degree level full-fledged online education programme started to provide quality education to students of deprived sections of the society as well as those who do not have access to higher education. Through this initiative Gross Enrolment Ratio will be increased.

Looking ahead

In 2030, it is estimated that India's higher education will adopt transformative and innovative approaches and will emerge as a single largest provider of global talent, with one in four graduates in the world being a product of the Indian higher education system.

5.4.2 Health

Depending on the level of care required, healthcare in India is broadly classified into three types. This classification includes primary care (provided at primary health centres), secondary care (provided at district hospitals), and tertiary care institutions (provided at specialised hospitals like AIIMS). Primary health care infrastructure provides the first level of contact between health professionals and the population. Broadly, based on the population served and the type of